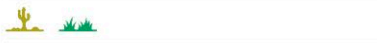


Sminthopsis crassicaudata

Fat-tailed dunnart



Length 2¼–3½ in (6–9 cm)
Tail 1½–2¼ in (4–7 cm)
Weight ¾–1½ oz (10–20 g)
Location Australia
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern



Widespread in wood, scrub, and dry grassland, the fat-tailed dunnart has benefited from the spread of grazing farmland. It has fawn or brown upper fur and white underparts. It actively searches by night across open soil and leaf litter for grubs, worms, and similar small invertebrates. It is solitary during the breeding season of August to March, but at other times small groups, of less than 10, may huddle together in sheltered crevices, logs, or burrows during cold periods.

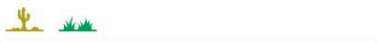


Antechinomys laniger

Kultarr



Length 2¾–4 in (7–10 cm)
Tail 4–6 in (10–15 cm)
Weight 7⁄8–1¼ oz (25–35 g)
Location C. and S. Australia
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern



Well adapted to a range of habitats, from scattered woodland to scrubby semidesert, the kultarr preys at night on grubs and

similar small invertebrates. It bounds on its relatively large, 4-toed rear feet, but lands on its front legs (like a rabbit). It has large ears and dark-ringed eyes, a thin, pointed face, and a compact body. Its long tail has a dark-tufted tip. The fur is fawn or brown above and white underneath.



Parantechinus apicalis

Dibbler



Length 4–6½ in (10–16 cm)
Tail 3–4¾ in (7.5–12 cm)
Weight 17⁄16–4 oz (40–125 g)
Location S.W. Australia
Social unit Individual
Status Endangered



After a gap of some 80 years, this species was rediscovered in 1967 in extreme southwest Australia and in 1985 on 2 offshore islands. Distinctive

features include a white eye-ring, white-flecked “grizzled” gray-brown fur, a well-haired, short, tapering tail, and large canine teeth for killing prey. This includes small vertebrates, such as mice, birds, and lizards, as well as insects and other invertebrates.



Pseudantechinus macdonnellensis

Fat-tailed false antechinus



Length 3¾–4¼ in (9.5–10.5 cm)
Tail 3–3¼ in (7.5–8.5 cm)
Weight 11⁄16–1½ oz (20–45 g)
Location W. and C. Australia
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern



When well fed, this insectivorous, nocturnal species, also called the red-eared antechinus, has a carrot-shaped tail swollen with fat (as a food store). Its fur is gray-brown, with red patches behind the ears and gray-white underparts. It prefers dry, rocky areas with clumped bushes and grass. After a gestation of 45–55 days, the female carries 6 young, one on each teat in her pouch, for 40 days. She suckles them in a nest until 14 weeks.



Dasycercus byrnei

Kowari



Length 5¼–7 in (13.5–18 cm)
Tail 4¼–5½ in (11–14 cm)
Weight 2½–6 oz (70–175 g)
Location C. Australia
Social unit Individual
Status Vulnerable



Despite a squirrel-like appearance and bushy, black-tufted tail, the kowari is a burrow-dwelling carnivore. It kills large prey, such as lizards, birds, and rodents, by holding them in its front paws and biting repeatedly and rapidly. It also eats insects and similar creatures, mostly more than ¾ in (1 cm) long. The

kowari is solitary and extends its burrow after rain, which softens the stony soil in its harsh, sparsely vegetated desert habitat. It marks its burrow and home range with urine, feces, and chin- and chest-gland scents, and communicates with neighbors through chatters, hisses, and flicks of its tail.



Dasyurus viverrinus

Eastern quoll



Length 11–18 in (28–45 cm)
Tail 6½–11 in (17–28 cm)
Weight 1½–4½ lb (0.7–2 kg)
Location Tasmania
Social unit Individual
Status Endangered



Last seen on the Australian mainland in the 1960s, in Sydney’s suburbs, this catlike marsupial (sometimes called the spotted native cat) now survives only in Tasmania. It hunts on the ground by night for small mammals, birds, and other vertebrates, and large insects; it also eats fruit, grass, and carrion. Quolls occupy varied woody, shrubby, and grassy habitats, as provided by mixed agriculture. The male is longer and 50 percent heavier than the female.

MATERNAL CARE



Like many female marsupials, the quoll has a large litter, up to 30, but only 6 nipples in her pouch, so only 6 young can survive. They attach for 8 weeks, then remain in the den as the mother goes off to feed and returns to suckle. She regularly takes them to new dens, often by piggyback.

Dasycercus cristicauda

Crest-tailed mulgara



Length 4¾–8 in (12–20 cm)
Tail 3–4¼ in (7.5–11 cm)
Weight 2½–6¾ oz (76–185 g)
Location C. Australia
Social unit Individual
Status Near threatened



This inhabitant of sandy desert with scattered spinifex (hummock grass) resembles the kowari (above) in body form and, like several similar species, has a fat-swollen tail base. Its fur is sandy brown on the upperparts, off-white below, with a crest of black hairs on the tail’s upper surface toward the tip. Its burrow varies from single, simple, and short to a system of tunnels with 5–6 entrances. At night, the crest-tailed mulgara hunts small rodents, lizards, birds, and large insects, and may also tackle large centipedes.

SPOTTED COAT



Slim and agile, the eastern quoll has white spots on its brown or black body, but not on the tail. The ears are large and erect.